



Understanding and Developing Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) :How to Improve the Visibility and Awareness of the Public Policy Analysis Program at Tampere University

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ABSTRACT

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Understanding and Developing key Performance Indicators (KPIs) :How to Improve the Visibility and Awareness of the Public Policy Analysis Program at Tampere University

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This study exhibits at how Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) can be created and can be used to improve how well known the Master's Programme in Public Policy at Tampere University. The Tampere University has a good reputation; the program isn't very well known that causes difficulty in attracting prospective students. The research is to understand how visible the program is in Asian market and how it is different from other European university which offers similar or same course. The study used a mix of qualitative methods and data collected from publicly available sources and case studies.

There was also a small survey aimed at current and future students. The interviews with university officials didn't happen because the management weren't available during the research time. So, the main analysis comes from publicly available information. The results show that most people find out about the Public Policy program through informal ways, like social media and word of mouth, not through official marketing. People know Finland and Tampere University are good for education and offer international options, but they don't know much about what makes the Public Policy program special.

When compared with other Nordic universities, it's clear that successful visibility often comes from strong branding for the program, storytelling through digital platforms, and support from alumni.

Keywords: Program Visibility, Higher Education Marketing, Public Policy, Tampere

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GLOSSARY

KPI Key Performance Index PPA- Public Policy Analysis

UNU-MERIT-United Nations University- Maastricht Economic and Social Research Institute on Innovation and Technology

SEO- Search Engine Optimization BSC- Balanced Scorecard

AI- Artificial Intelligence

OECD- Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development NGO- Non-Government Organization

SME- Subject Matter Expert

CRM-Customer Relationship Management CTA- Call To action

CTR-Click Through Rate DM-Digital Marketing

EU-European Union

PR -Public Relations

Chapter 1 : Introduction:

1.1 Background

Student Enrollment dynamics are shifting, and it is very necessary to understand the game in today's era. The decision-making process of a consumer solely depends on how well the brand is known to the consumer. When a brand awareness is high for a customer, it automatically creates an impact to consumer cognition they can easily remember so it turns it will a better impact to the brand. When the brand awareness is low for a customer, it will create low impact to consumer cognition so, they may not prefer the unknown brand. Internet today has made everything possible. Customers can search /research based on their preferences, so basically when we want our brand to stand out mostly, we have to talk to them through our webpages and campaigns. Therefore, it is at most es-essential for a brand to use internet to create and increase brand awareness for its own advantage.

When it comes to student enrollment, when there is a well-known brand, it will affect decision making process while deciding a university .To be known as a versatile brand, university should create an image that will attract students. Brand awareness is core component of brand equity, which a pre-requisite for decision making process. Brand equity is the value of the brand "Tampere university" adds to the product beyond the product itself.

There are mainly two components according to Harvard university to brand equity.

- A) Brand awareness: Does the students know about the university ? Can they re-memner the Tampere university name or logo?
- B) Brand Knowledge: What comes to mind when student think of Tampere University? Say for example, Quality of education? Job opportunity? Finland? Wider opportunity in the market?

These things will matter and students don't mind going extra mile by paying extra when the brand equity is higher. This way brand doesn't need to worry about competitors in the market and also any new launch can reach people easily. There are methodologies to build the equity for the brand to create better image and visibility. The constant measurement of brand equity will help to understand where the brand stands. Measurements can be done through three lenses

according to Harvard study, brand awareness can be measured through surveys, search volume, social mentions. Brand relevance can be measured through customer satisfaction NPS, Product attribute studies. Brand power can be measure through preference surveys, demand studies. We can describe brand awareness as the ability of the consumers to recall or recognize the brand during the decision-making process or at least know the brand (Keller,2008)

Despite its strategic importance, understanding and measuring brand equity is difficult.

To address the gap, frameworks such as that initiated by Qualtrics (2024) offer and integrate two complementary approaches to measure : Operational (O-Data)- Based on sales numbers, Financial metrics, and operational performance helps to understand what is happening in the market and other one is Experiential Data (X-Data) -helps to understand how customers see and value the brand , their loyalty towards the brand more like why it is happening.

While all these will help, but in order for the organization to understand they must translate strategic objectives into solid Key performance index(KPI's) so that they can be monitored for long time. Without KPI's rest remains only conceptual idea rather than actional business objective. According to Bunzel(2007).organization shouldn't ignore building the brand and creating awareness of the brand. Familiarity between a customer and brand creates brand awareness.

It creates encouragement like responses from clients where they can go through recalling, recognizing and be familiar with institution A brand that as of till now exists runs a procedure called brand reinforcement to increase their brand awareness (Percy et al., 2006; Islam et al., 2021). Awareness created by higher institutions will help students in their decision-making process (Gibbs & Dean, (2015)).

1.2 Case Company : Tampere university

Tampere universities came into action at 2019 when Tampere university of technology and university of Tampere were merged .It is a bold and forward-thinking academic community fabricated on internationalization ,societal impact and Multidisciplinary research. They have thriving university community with over 22,500 students and 4.200 staff over 80 nationalities .

They have from engineering social health to medicines. They have academic publishing over 3600 peer reviewed scientific articles annually. According to Tampere university 2024 annual review ,student enrollment saw inclined growth around 2% from 2022.The total international students from the degrees-Bachelors, Masters and doctoral , year 2024 recorded 17,726 students .

The Master's program in Tampere university- Public Policy Analysis is a niche program . The program offers holistic approach on public policy analysis,inter-grating economic tools to address broad societal problems. The program is handled by Ms.Katri Sieburg.

1.3 Purpose of the study:

In today's fast-paced, quickly changing competitive world of higher education, the academic programs must not only need to keep up with academic excellence but also actively promote their programs to attract and retain talented students, faculty, and funding partners. Competitions are magnified by global presence of well-established public policy schools across US and other parts of Europe ,UK due to greater brand recognition and larger alumni network. It is a challenge to outreach program specific marketing activities when compared to Faculty or university wide campaigns.

Public Policy programs, in particular, face the challenge of differentiating themselves in a crowded marketplace where visibility, reputation, and perceived value significantly influence prospective students' choices. Even though building strong brand is important, many academic programs don't succeed in the way they want the program to reach people. The public policy program is in a

situation it's not getting enough attention. Low target outreach could be a one of the reasons why the program visibility is low. The intended purpose of the study is to understand the existing marketing strategies used to enhance the Public Policy program visibility and awareness which helps to explore and develop various marketing strategies that can enhance the brand among target audience. Creating KPIs to access and identify the potential areas for improvement. This research will provide actionable pointers to enhance the program goal and the finding will help the client to make data driven decisions for overall impact.

1.4 Research Gap

Although many literature studies show on KPI's used in higher education as part of marketing activities ,most research emphasize on general context , there are only focus on specific ones. This leaves a gap in understanding how specialized niche programs like public policy Analysis can enhance visibility ,attract prospective students and strengthen the course reputations.

1.5 Research Questions:

The research responds to main strategic question:

What Marketing strategies can be used to enhance the visibility of the program so that student enrollment increases?

Sub-Questions:

- What are the current KPIS used at each Marketing funnel stage?
- Which KPIs can be added to enhance the performance of the program brand visibility and awareness?
- How can we bridge the gap between the existing gaps in creating brand awareness , improving brand visibility to achieve the result?
- What areas currently shows the strength and what are the gaps at present in the strategies used?

1.6 Practical and ethical issues:

1.6.1 Does the research raise any ethical concerns that need to be resolved?

- All the conduct rules are strictly followed such a sending consent form before collecting data and data confidentiality will be strictly maintained.
- Approval was required from Tampere university for understanding existing marketing strategies used.

1.6.2 Are there any potential problems of research access?

- There was a difficulty in gaining access with inhouse marketing team to share some data's.

1.6.3 Are there any resource issues such as e.g. access to specialist databases?

- Gaining data access from university was challenging

1.6.4 Are there issues of commercial confidentiality or intellectual property rights?

- All the data collected are anonymized to respect confidentiality and intellectual property rights.

Chapter 2 : Literature Review:

2.1 Introduction:

The purpose of the literature review is to examine and integrate contemporary scholarship development and application of Key performance Index(KPI's) within higher education and also how to improve brand visibility and create awareness of the program. In an increasing competitive higher education land-scape, university let alone now a days to gain each program visibility , programs head should work on promoting the program to attract prospective students and enhance program and institution profile. Specialized Programs like Public policy might face challenges in achieving visibility and awareness due to their niche focus and also to the competition with more general social science programs. A well-defined KPI's which serves as tool to monitor , evaluate , and optimize marketing and communication will contribute to program's performance and outreach success .The chapter will offer coherent foundation of understanding how universities measure their performance, KPI's, and also different methods researched on brand visibility.

The current study is situated with broader academic discourse, with literature review providing knowledge for research problem it helps to understand brand equity, visibility, awareness, KPI's,digital engagement better. In doing so, it helps to bridge in gap that I found out, especially to program specific marketing for public policy analysis. The literature review will help to inform the research design by helping to choose selection of analytical framework and methodological approaches which will establish the study is backed by existing pool of knowledge while contributing to new insights. Finally , this will justify the purpose of the study by addressing the gaps which can led to more evidence-based strategies that can enhance visibility , and improve the student enrollment for programs such as Master's in Public Policy Analysis at Tampere university .

2.2 Theoretical Frameworks and Foundations:

2.2.1 Understanding Full-Funnel Marketing in Higher Education:

Education Dynamics (2024), provides a holistic approach on strategies that students take from -initial awareness through to enrollment (Beyond) .The traditional method was to just focus on lead generation but times have changed and methods were improved .No two-customer journey are same .The approach is:

Upper funnel awareness :

In this stage, the concept explained us understand how to capture initial attention so that institution gets noticed. For instance, Impressions, Brand recall, website traffic , Unique visitor count, and engagement time will be part of the first stage.

Middle-Funnel Engagement :

In this stage, institution should create an environment to nurture interest and helping students to consider the course. For instance, During Pre-Inquiry author suggests cost per lead, inquiry volume, engagement with content can be used to elevate the first stage of process. During post-inquiry stage, offer acceptance rate, Lead Conversion, Completion rate will help in this stage.

Final- Funnel Engagement :

In this stage, institution should continue engagement after a student inquiry to push into sales funnel and turn prospect into enrolled student .During this , Yield rate, CPE, AND Deferral rate will help.



Figure 1:Marketing Funnel Stages

2.2.2 Examining Marketing Strategies:

Seong-Won Eum(2025), the student shows how digital marketing strategies (Social media ,blogs,website,SMS, telemarketing affects students' decision making in choosing university department and their perception of departmental image.

Drawing from 156 students in south Korea and analyzed through partial least square(PLS) the study observes that social media marketing, blogs, and SMS campaign are more effective method tool that leads students to choose department and enrollment .The study also explores how telemarketing or search engine marketing has no effect on student enrollment to department or departmental image. The study explain how different tools were implemented in different stages of Marketing funnel social media for awareness stage.

The educational institute should adopt different digital marketing strategies aligned with student decision making process. This study will help me to develop

KPI aligned with funnel stage for creating visibility of the Program at Tampere university of applied sciences .

Anna Filip(2012), the paper explores overall marketing theory that can be applied in higher education in Romania. University in Romania are struggling to attract prospective students to enroll due to underfunding, weak legislation ,and decline in birth rates .The paper is theoretical and literature-based analysis. The methodology adopted was Kotler seeing two different perceptive on marketing Service Marketing and Social Marketing. Social Marketing perspective is universities are responsible for educating society where university should balance individual goals i.e., student needs and also collective goals i.e., societal needs. Where in , Service based marketing is when education is seen as service .It has unique features like intangible, inseparable, Heterogenous etc. The application of Marketing elements is increasing in recent time even more than when the paper was published. The university should shape the way and deliver their offering.

The study shows how developing different marketing P's as per Kotler & Fox help university Programme refers to academic offering that establish university identity .However, Romanian institutes have been critiqued for less internationalization, overspecialization .Price has become essential factor in students choosing their courses particularly in times of economic crisis .Place concerns about the environment, e-learning for providing broader opportunities for wider reach. Promotion stage, university should carry out communicating strategies from advertising to audience. Processes comprise of admin, teaching and Its infrastructure and final is People where staff ,faculty, students are important in shaping students' perception and overall reputation of institute.

Dr.Lingam Sampath (2024) explores various metrics and methodologies used to assess digital marketing performance and ROI. Key performance indicators (KPIs) such as website traffic, social media engagement, email open rates, and paid advertising costs are analyzed for their role in providing actionable insights. This paper has shown practical applications of these metrics and analysis methods and publishing their effectiveness. Clark (2019) emphasis on a practical approach to measure social media marketing performance.

Metrics like engagement rates (likes, shares, and comments), reach, and impressions will be measured. The study focus on how these metrics can be used to pull the success of social media campaigns and their impact on brand awareness and customer engagement .

Mark Anthony Camilleri(2019) focuses on generic approach to analyze the marketing environment .The approach to analyze the marketing environment and SWOT were provided to examine macro and micro environmental factors that may have impact in target audience. decline in birth rates .The paper is theoretical and literature-based analysis. The methodology adopted was Kotler seeing two different perceptive on marketing.

Hotjar(2024), emphasis on value of marketing funnel and customer understanding .The unique design will help to achieve the target audience attention. It focuses on qualitative and quantitative analysis will help to build better funnel that understands customer needs and also retains them. Naidoo, V & Wu, T. (2011), Paper focuses on Mixed-design methodologies on universities in certain areas. This study is focused on international students and how university carries out marketing strategies to attract the audience. This paper emphasis on Execution part of marketing rather than planning part of marketing.

2.2.3 Brand Equity and models.

Vijayalakshmi Menon(2016) ,emphasis on model of Aaker's Brand equity model in context of Indian higher education. The study shows awareness alone isn't enough KPI's must also track perceived quality and loyalty towards the brand .The study shows the model will work if its adapted .The results shows that students focus more on perceived quality (Teaching, facilities, outcomes) and building brand loyalty should be done through student experience and alumni engagement .The study shows treating brand awareness without quality improvement might cause a backfire. Kevin(1993), Study defines on Customer - based brand equity (CBBE), it shows that customer reacts to the brand which is known and recognized. It shows that brand equity comes from knowledge in the customer's mind. The study emphases on brand awareness and brand image and it is very important for gaining positive association. The measurement was done by asking customers about the brand or testing their reactions to understand where the brand stands.

Galyna(2021), the paper highlights the increasing competition in international market for higher education. It states that strong brand will enhance visibility, attract better prospects for enrolment and foster relationship with various stakeholder.

Balindong (2018) the study observed into what high school students think when they pick their academic subjects. Their study found that things *like personal interest, feeling passionate about a subject, and being influenced by others are big factors* in their choices. On the other hand, factors like *job market needs and the school environment* are not as important to them. This shows that when university promoting the course, its better to focus on the aspect of how the course connects with personal interest and emotions of students but not just career opportunities. Also, using numbers and measurements should include things like how curious students seem or how much their teachers or mentors recommend the program, so we get a full picture of how appealing and visible the program is.

2.2.4 SMART KPI Principles:

According to OCED, the paper explores indicators which are quantitative for supporting the implementation of education policies within OECD that is, translating strategic goals into measurable outcome and also by enabling evidence informed decision making. This paper completely focuses on SMART criteria so applying KPIS to this will make a meaningful achievable goal. The author

says balance mix of input, process, output is needed to track both resources and outcomes.

EvalCommunity(2025), the article states that logic model is a map that shows how program works. These are components in it "Input, Activities, output, outcomes". KPI's are easier to identify when organization know what they want to achieve at each step. This way, logic model will help to ensure KPI are aligned to objective and its

Shaulska et al. (2021), the study shows an implementation of KPI's at the university in Ukraine. Study implies difficulties faced when forming KPI's at higher education institute. The study shows understanding organizational culture, ensuring KPI's relevance and continuous evaluation will lead to better results. The study implies several obstacles were found such as evaluation difficulties of KPI's, independence of indicators and lack of influence.

Guthrie, Manes-Rossi, Orelli & Sforza(2024), the paper shows how the PPM(Performance management and measurement) has evolved overtime. It provides insights and scope for future research. The paper has 40 years of literature collected and analyzed. Its emphasis on five stages of PPM which universities adopt to grow. The Author has discussed about strategy, Activities& Processes, Performance Target, Reward System, Information System. The university has relied on Qualitative cases, Interviews, and document analysis.

2.2.5 Balanced scorecard in universities(BSC).

Justyna Fijałkowska & Cidalia Oliveira(2018), the study is theoretical and literature based addressing growing demand for enhanced transparency and accountability in universities to performance measurement frameworks which communicates values to stakeholder effectively. The model used here is BSC(Balanced Scorecard in universities).It draws attention to foundational concepts like Principle-agent theory, new managerialism, New Public management, and the new seed of Entrepreneurial university.

BSC was formulated by Kaplan and Norton (1992) which translates institution strategy and mission into actionable more quantifiable indicators for performance across various dimensions such as finance, stakeholder, internal processes, learning and growth .The university to gain advantage in this context, framework enables brands to align their strategy with measurable outcomes , which balances both traditional financial metrics and academic stakeholder ambition. Fijałkowska and Oliveira (2018) counter that the Balanced Scorecard gives universities a strong tool to improve transparency and accountability. This is especially important because of the pressures from new managerialism and the need for stakeholders to see evidence of value. Their study, which is based on literature and includes relevant case studies, like early uses in California, shows how the Balanced Scorecard works well in putting university strategies into action and measuring performance.

Camilleri (2021) supports this flexibility by suggesting a four-part model for universities: how satisfied stakeholders are, how well internal processes work, the organization's ability to operate (including people and innovation), and how well it manages money.

In Real-world examples show how useful the BSC is: the University of Akron's "Charting the Course" BSC program follows progress in areas like innovation, community health, and economic growth; other schools like Rutgers use the model to look at teaching quality, research output, and how satisfied employees are. BSC Designer But there are still challenges.

Arzamastseva and Khayrullina (2017) point out problems such as people resisting change, not having a clear plan, and unfair sharing of resources. The Academic Score-card, which some universities use, changes the standard BSC by not including financial goals, making it more suitable for public and non-profit educational settings.

2.2.6 Service -Dominant Logic in Higher Education

The Recent study done by Maria de Fátima Cruz, Helena Alves & Ricardo Gouveia Rodrigues(2024) , shows how co-creation (Stakeholder & Students) co-create and collaborate in delivering and reshaping educational institutes .The author through systematic literature review identify key elements in co-creation

- Student involvement
- Service value expectations
- Value Co-creations
- Enabling tools
- Barriers and outcomes.

This method offers pathway for enhancing course/program visibility and stakeholder engagement .Development of KPI's like student -led promotional activities

,Alumni participation in outreach, Stakeholder satisfaction metrics, and use of co-creations tolls will help. These methods when combined with Filips 7'ps Marketing mix can yield better results so, Co-creation into designing KPI's supports strategic shift from passive promotions more into engaged collaboration which can amplify the results faster and effective.

Chapter 3: METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter describes technique and procedure that is used to identify and analyses information. This has research design, data collection methods, Data analysis methods. The method carried out for this topic is Mixed-Method Research design methodology. Enabling a compressive understanding of the topic.

The qualitative part has explored previous case studies that helps to understand marketing strategies used in higher education, also, includes different perspective through different models used in marketing mix, understanding brand equity better in Higher education.

The quantitative part has explored data of existing visibility of the program through metrics such as website traffic, social media engagement and also suggest various methods to enhance the visibility of the program through deriving KPI"s. By combing both qualitative and quantitative evidence , the study has generated comprehensive framework of KPIs that can help Ms. Katri in making informed , data-driven decisions about the program .

3.2 Research Design

In this study, a mix of qualitative and quantitative research methods are used to understand the holistic view of the problem. This combination of methods guides to understand the study from different perspective , which makes the results more reliable and accurate.

The first part of the study has involved looking at specific case studies and also exploring various Marketing concepts . By Exploring the qualitative data , we have learned what worked, what went wrong , and what best practices can be applied to Tampere University's program. Using surveys, open ended questions are sent to target audience through email /WhatsApp .This is done to understand and analyses the target audience preference on this course and their

willing ness to shift to Finland. By this way, we have observed the pattern and focus and invest marketing strategies in areas which has higher response. Studies are done across Asia. However, Interview was not conducted with Tampere university in-house marketing team due to unavailability but the main reason at the start of thesis it was considered is because author wants to understand the current practices. Observations were made and analyzed, European market might also be considered depending on the opportunity.

The Latter part of the study uses numbers and data to measure how visible the program is. In lay man terms, I have look at things like how many people visit the program's website, how much activity there is on social media, how many people attend events, and how many applications the program gets. This is done with whatever publicly available data was there since data was not handed over.

By using both a qualitative and quantitative approach the study was carried out in an effective way .It provided deep insights into people's perspective and real data about how visible the program is combining these together, the study not only finds important measures of visibility but also shows how these measures can be used to make the Public Policy Analysis program more well-known both in Finland and around the world.

3.3 Data Collection Methods

3.3.1 Introduction

Data Collection is the most fundamental stage in this research process, the accuracy and relevancy depend hugely on the rigor of data collected and them approach in collection(SurveyCTO,2023).The broader data collection methods are documented here as literature , and along with surveys , interviews, secondary data analysis are done.

3.3.2 Qualitative Analysis :

3.3.2.1 Document Analysis and Digital Analytics

The initial stage was conducted by understanding the existing marketing materials available and given to me by Tampere university in context to overall institute or the specific program so, as a researcher I have understood the current visibility of the program .

The program specific digital analytics has carried out including website traffic, social media performance metrics, and other forms of engagement that are needed. It was created as baseline for program visibility

3.3.2.2 Surveys

The service dominant logic method was used , where in Structured surveys are sent out to alumni , current students and prospective students. The open and closed ended questions has formed and rolled out. This has helped the study with measurable data on awareness and perception while it also provides richer insights into stakeholder suggestions and expectation.

3.3.2.3 Interviews:

Semi-structured/in-formal interview was supposed to be conducted with faculty, marketing staff associated with Tampere university of Applied Sciences. It didn't go as per plan .The purpose of this interview is to gather knowledge on communication strategies and challenges currently used to promote and also understand the challenges existing in enhancing its visibility and what strategies were effective and ineffective in the past.

Surveys were formed in a way that has steered the topics like communication channels, Target audience, and perceived visibility .Open ended questions has allowed to understand and open to new suggestions and ideas on enhancing the visibility which were not previously considered.

3.3.2.4 Case Studies:

Comparative studies were conducted on grounds of similar niche program or same public policy analysis at other European universities. The program has been selected based on their comparable size, internationalization, and also academic reputation. This case study was used to identify concrete strategies that can contribute to improve visibility. I.e. Alumni engagement activities, targeted social audience, partnership with other organization, and also understanding use of performance measurement frameworks.

By understanding and analyzing existing case studies, these two are expected outcomes

- A) They have helped to set a benchmark enabling Tampere university program to be assessed against best examples.
- B) It provided rich literature i.e, examples of how visibility challenges have addressed in other university across different European countries. It has addressed both success and also challenges faced.

By analyzing these it has provided transferrable lessons and helps them to adopt to KPI's for Tampere university.

3.3.2.5 Sampling

The process has direct people included who are relevant to this objective of the research i.e. students, admin staff. This process carried out was Purposive Sampling. The goal is to have best insights from people who have real experience with the program rather than random sampling.

- **Current students** :Helped the research understand how visible the program within the university? To understand how effective communication strategies enrolled students are ?
 - **Alumni**: Helped to understand how visible the programme in the real-world environment .
 - **Faculty/administration** :Understand existing marketing strategies, resources available , what are the challenges .
 - **Prospective students** :Helps the study understand how they came to know , do they value to consider, what communication channels reach them ?
- The number of samples collected are small because its more qualitative focused research where depth and richness of insights matter .

3.4 Data Analysis:

This section explains how the data was handled. The research study has used Mixed-Method techniques .

3.4.1 Qualitative Analysis:

The section has interviews , survey questions and case study notes. These are analyzed by thematic coding which helps me to understand or repeat the ideas The following steps are: Transcription ,Initial coding, grouping into categories, Forming themes. This explains why the numbers look the way it did.

3.4.2 Quantitative Analysis:

This section explains with survey and Digital analytics data usage. The process is carried out by Descriptive Statistics .This process has analyzed trends and compare and find gaps. .This has helped to create baseline for measurable KPI.

3.4.3 Integration of findings:

The method of triangulation was carried out by using different data sources to confirm findings.

CHAPTER 4: DATA ANALYSIS

4.1 Introduction:

Since I couldn't get access to internal data from Tampere University, I did all the data analysis using secondary sources. This way, I can still look at how visible and well-known the Master's Programme in Public Policy is, based on public information. This method helps keep things fair and clear, even without using private data.

The study looks at how the program is presented online, what messages are used in marketing materials, and how its digital presence compares to other universities that offer similar programs which can help me to build a practical and fitting set of KPI on improving visibility.

4.2 Why Use Secondary Data

When I initially planned for this study, I was expecting guidance on internal data but I had my doubts that's why I had earlier mentioned in limitation I can proceed to handle more into the study if I am provided data by the marketing team but unfortunately I had use publicly available sources like websites, social media, online content, and search rankings to understand about the visibility but it gave important clues about how well the program is known and how people interact with it (Saunders, Lewis & Thornhill, 2019). I was able to do these

- Find gaps where the program's marketing could be better.
- See how respondents are responding to the program's content.
- Compare how visible the program is with similar programs at other universities through case study
- Recommend KPIs that are based on real-world examples and practices.

For this study, the method for choosing for comparative analysis is done if it achieves these following criteria:

- English taught Master's degree program in public policy or any closely relevant field.
- Availability of publicly accessible data on visibility and engagement activities

4.3 Data Interpretation

The data analysis was done by comparative content analysis. This process makes sure there is a consideration and bridge is built by using common strengths and weaknesses across the areas chosen by me. Each observation was connected to possible performance indicators. For instance, website traffic was measured by the number of indexed pages, and social media engagement was measured by how many times program-related posts were made. I could not fetch any direct numbers like those from Google Analytics or CRM systems, but other qualities done to measure visibility such as how often content was updated, how detailed the stories were, and how consistent the visual style was.

4.4 Limitations

This study was done with the data that was already available and open to view in public forum .There is no data which is internal like

- Real web traffic numbers.
- Social media reach and how people interact with posts.
- Information on how many people apply versus how many actually enroll.

the results show what can be seen online, not how well the marketing is working inside the organization. However, this doesn't make the analysis less useful. Instead, it means the study is more like a starting point for understanding how things are seen, how easy they are to find, and how messages are shared.

4.5 Document Analysis and Digital Analytics

Unfortunately, this part of the study was not carried out due to data unavailability.

4.6 Survey

A total of 19 responses were gathered from students who are either currently studying or planning to study, coming from different educational and geographical backgrounds, mostly from India and Finland. The data included what people knew about public policy, how much they knew about Tampere University, where they got their information from, and what motivated them to choose a particular program.

The analysis used a mix of descriptive and thematic methods. Numbers were used to show how often certain answers appeared, like how many said "Very Important." Open-ended answers were grouped into themes to find common ideas about people's views, awareness, and expectations. The below analysis was made based on the funnel stages.

4.6.1 Awareness Stage: Program Recognition

Table 1: Awareness Stage observation

Key Finding	Observation
Primary information sources	The most common sources were social media (LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook) and friends or alumni. A few respondents learned about the program via the university website or education fairs.
General awareness of Tampere University	Only about 40–45% of respondents had prior knowledge of Tampere University before exploring higher education options. Those aware of the university mainly associated it with quality education, innovation, and international exposure.
Google/Search engine visibility	Several respondents reported discovering opportunities in Finland through independent browsing, showing that search visibility plays a moderate but crucial role.
Interpretation	Awareness of the Public Policy program is largely dependent on peer networks and general institutional reputation, not structured marketing campaigns. Social media visibility is present but not program-specific.

Based on the numerical survey , the below *figure2* shows how much does respondents are aware about the program and the university .It is analyzed that KPI should include social media reach and also referral tracking .

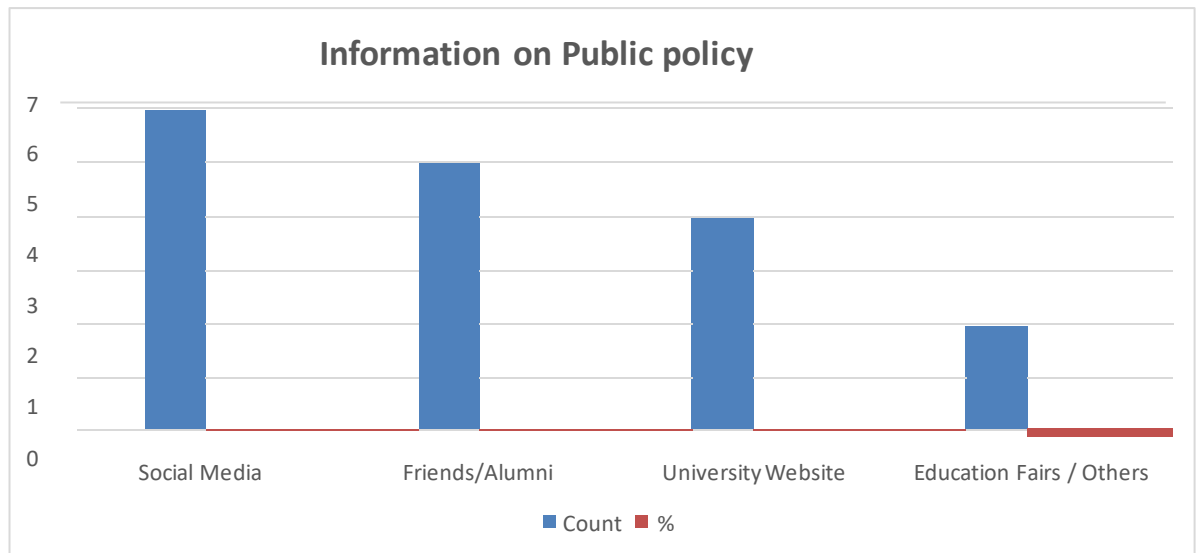


Figure 2: Information on Public Policy awareness

4.6.2 Consideration Stage :Motivation to study

Table 2: Consideration Stage observation

Area	Findings
Understanding of “Public Policy”	Most respondents described it as the study of government decisions, their societal impact, and ways to improve policy effectiveness. Some associated it with “problem-solving” or “understanding governance.” A minority were uncertain about its meaning, indicating partial conceptual clarity.
Motivation to study Public Policy	The strongest motivators were career opportunities in government and international organizations (UN, World Bank), research prospects, and personal interest in social impact.
Decision drivers	Respondents valued international exposure, networking opportunities, and Finland’s education quality as major decision factors.
Interpretation	Respondents perceive public policy as a career-enabling and socially impactful field, but awareness of specific program content and specialization options is limited.

The below *figure3* interprets that the major decision driver is **career growth (80%)**, followed by **international exposure (75%)**. Respondents link Public Policy to employability in government or NGOs, confirming the program’s appeal as a professional degree in future.

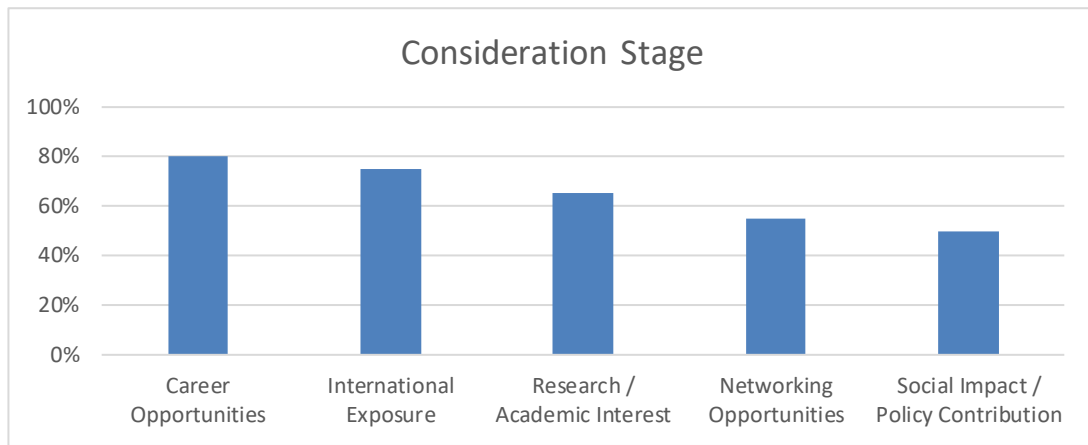


Figure 3: Information on Consideration perspective

4.6.3 Decision Stage :What does it affect to make a choice?

Table 3: Decision Stage observation

Key Observation	Interpretation
Key decision factors	“Career opportunities,” “international exposure,” and “Research opportunities” were consistently rated as Very Important.
Main concerns	Language barriers, job market uncertainty, and cost of living in Finland were identified as significant decision obstacles.
Perception of Tampere University	While recognized as a reputable institution, few respondents were aware of program-specific strengths. Those familiar described it as “innovative” and “research-oriented.”
Interpretation	Career outcomes and employability strongly influence decision-making; however, limited visibility of graduate success or internship pathways reduces program attractiveness.

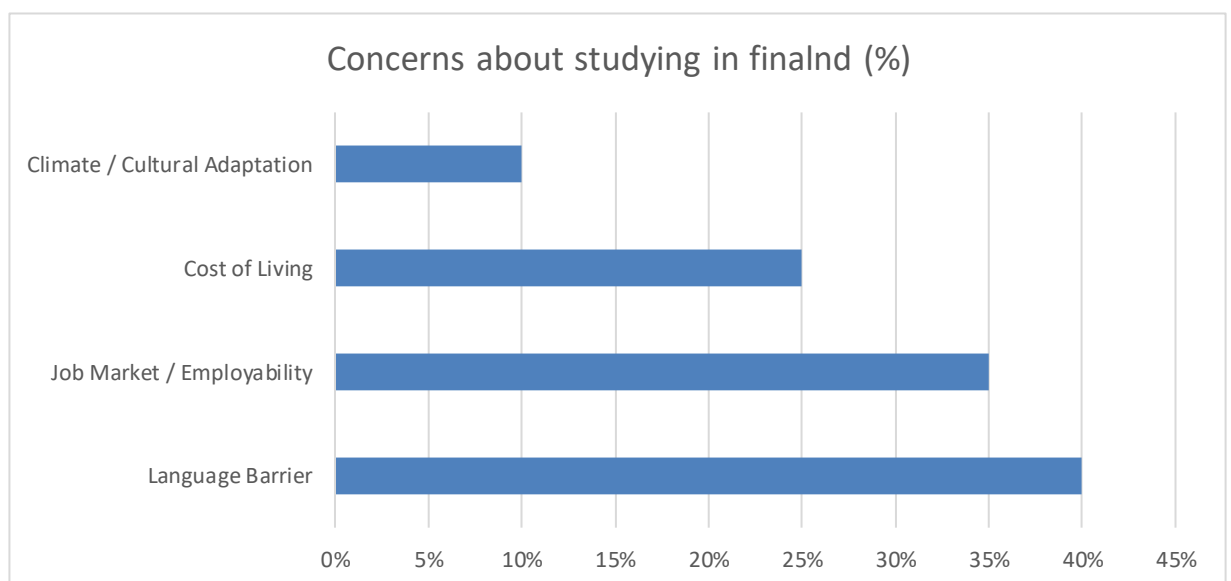


Figure 4: Information on concerns of the respondents

The *Figure4* interprets that , practical barriers such as **language** and **job prospects** are major enrollment hesitation among respondents who are currently either a student or future prospects , they also feel and indicate a need for communication strategies highlighting English-language support and employability data.

4.6.4 Retention & Advocacy Stage

Table 4: Retention Stage observation

Findings	Interpretation
Respondents expressed expectations of career networking, internships, and international exposure, but few referenced alumni networks or community involvement.	Indicates limited visibility of alumni success stories and post-graduate engagement channels.
Those already studying at Tampere University mentioned scholarships and academic support, but not active program promotion or public advocacy.	Suggests low program-level advocacy among current students and alumni.

The *below figure5*, interprets that post-graduation in that field , respondents are interested to work in the field of NGO/ Government which can reinforce the need to highlight the Tampere university international collaboration and adding alumni success stories in these sectors

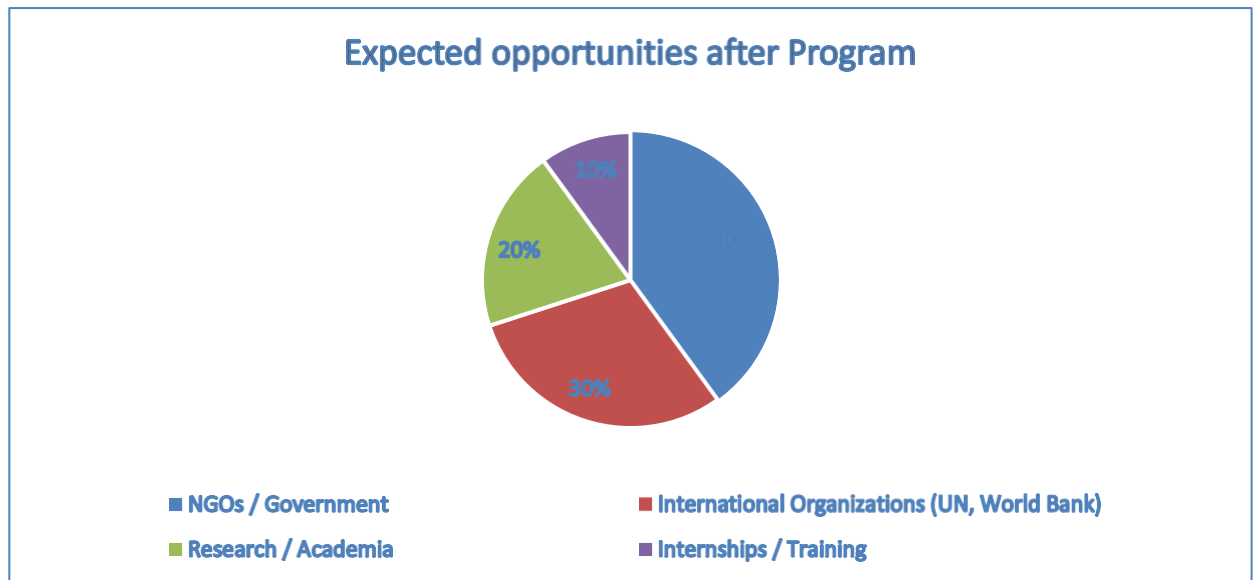


Figure 5 : Information on expected outcome

Based on the interpretation , it is shown that when deciding to invest in marketing we should not only focus on awareness stage rather give equal importance throughout the stages for sustained engagement.

In this study, demographics were also captured to understand whether digital outreach channels will be effective or not. The respondents were mostly 20-24 from Indian or Finland .

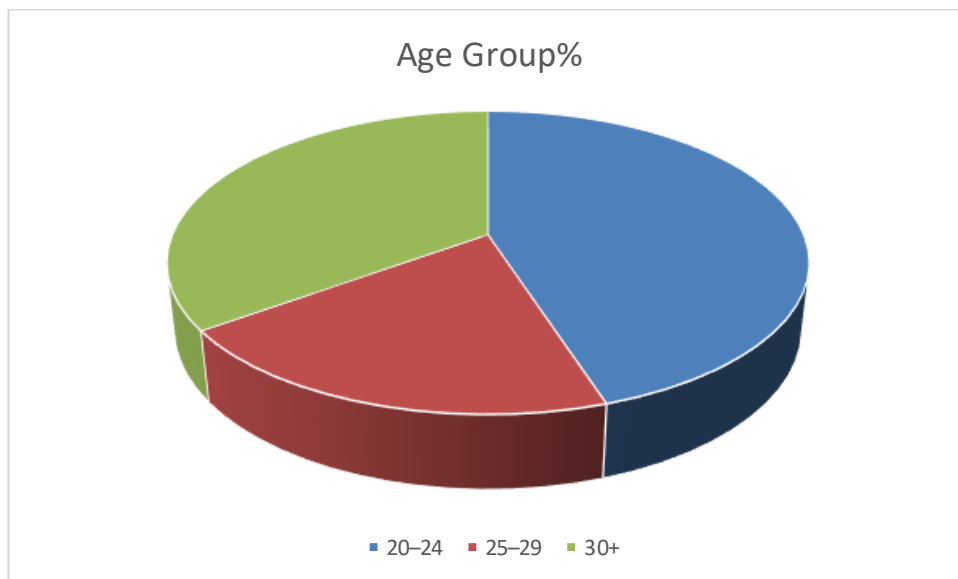


Figure 6 : Information on age group

4.7 Comparative Study Analysis :

4.7.1 Introduction:

This chapter compares how European universities /other nation university with programs in Public Policy or related social sciences promote their visibility and awareness.

The goal is to measure how Tampere University's Master's Programme in Public Policy stands against other well-known universities that have strong online presence and communication strategies.

By looking at the advantages, areas needing improvement, and effective marketing methods used by similar universities, this chapter helps create specific Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) to enhance the visibility of the program.

The comparison is organized based on four KPI groups from the marketing funnel model Awareness, Consideration, Decision, and Retention & Advocacy followed by a summary of all the findings.

Benchmarking table :

This is a benchmarking tool but all the metrics will be considered based on the availability of data online .The below table ideal benchmarking metrics that should be considered when creating comparative analysis .

Table 5: Benchmarking

Funnel Stage	Dimension	Indicators
Awareness	Website visibility, SEO ranking, social media	Google ranking, content updates, post frequency
Consideration	Engagement and communication	Webinar offerings, Q&A sessions, response rate to inquiries
Decision	Application conversion and clarity of process	Clear application guidelines, alumni stories, FAQs
Retention & Advocacy	Alumni involvement, partnerships	Alumni networks, policy institution collaborations
Overall	KPI usage and transparency	Availability of performance dashboards or metrics

4.2.1 The medical university of South Carolina (MUSC) case study:

MUSC partnered with Carnegie Higher Ed to promote and enhance its brand visibility and reputation .The main objective of this study is to create more wider national awareness, and also promote its brand across both education and healthcare. This case study is relevant to our current study as it will act as a benchmarking . It will provide and demonstrate a practical application of KPI's driven strategies to improve the brand visibility .This case study has used Mixed-method and comparative approach which is similar to this current study. By examining the MUSC case study , this can provide insights into effective KPI's design, measurement of performance, and strategic marketing that can be adopted to TAMK public policy analysis program. he below tabular column provides comparative analysis done and also mentioned proposed methods for the university

4.2.2 University of Helsinki case study

The University of Helsinki focuses on research related to welfare, governance, and digitalization within the field of social and public policy. Although the University of Helsinki does not have a master's program specifically labeled as "Public Policy and Human Development," it collaborates on a notable joint program: the MSc in Public Policy and Human Development (MPP), offered by UNU-MERIT in partnership with Maastricht University.

The MPP program focuses on designing policies, monitoring their effectiveness, and evaluating outcomes. It also equips students with both quantitative and qualitative methods to address global governance, innovation, and development challenges.

Because this program is a collaboration between UNU-MERIT and Maastricht University, it benefits from the recognition and visibility of both institutions an important factor when assessing visibility and awareness in the KPI study. In terms of digital and partner visibility, the MPP program offers publicly accessible elements such as detailed program descriptions, specializations like Migration Studies and Governance of Innovation on the Maastricht University website, and downloadable brochures. The presence of such information suggests that the program uses multimedia content and international partnerships to boost its visibility. The detailed comparative study is done .

Table 6: MUSC Case Study

KPI Category	Example Metrics	MUSC Case Study Analysis	Proposed for Tampere University (Specific to Public Policy Analysis)
Digital Outreach KPIs	Website clicks, social media engagement, webinar attendance	150,000 click-throughs; multi-channel campaigns	Track website visits, social media engagement, webinar registration & participation
Brand Awareness KPIs	Awareness level, recognition in target audience	Significant improvement in brand familiarity nationally	Survey respondents' recognition of program, mentions in professional networks ie, linkedin , naukri etc.
Perception KPIs	Clarity of program message, perceived value	Brand clarity improved; stakeholders report consistent messaging	Collect survey ratings on clarity, perceived quality, and uniqueness of the content
Engagement KPIs	Inquiries, newsletter opens, event participation	High engagement through campaigns; tracking via metrics	Track inquiries from website & email campaigns, online event participation, newsletter opens
Comparative/Benchmark KPIs	Performance vs peers	Benchmarked against similar medical schools	Compare Tampere's digital presence, awareness, and engagement metrics with 2–3 similar European/Asian programs(Sweden

Table 7: University of Helsinki Case study

KPI Category	Key Indicators / Metrics	University of Helsinki	Tampere University	Benchmark Target for Tampere
Digital Outreach	Website traffic, domain authority, backlinks, webinar activity	Strong traffic (global reach, consistent webinars); Domain Authority ~88; frequent applicant webinars	Program-specific page live; Domain Authority ~82; limited webinars	Raise DA to ≥ 85 ; host at least 3–4 online events per semester
SEO Visibility	Keyword ranking (“Public Policy Finland”, “Social Science Research”)	Top 3 positions for key searches; multilingual optimization	Not in top 10 yet for program-level keywords	Achieve top 5 ranking for “Public Policy Finland” within 12 months
Brand Awareness	Social media followers, media mentions, international recognition	~351k followers; 113M social media reach (2021)	~18.8k Instagram followers; moderate visibility	Double social following within 1 year; feature in 2–3 international education platforms

Perception	Message clarity, alumni visibility, reputation surveys	Clear value proposition; strong alumni narratives	Messaging partially clear; alumni blog exists	Strengthen messaging clarity and alumni storytelling across all media
Engagement	Inquiries, newsletter sign-ups, content interactions, event attendance	~1.7M social interactions (2021); regular newsletters	No public data; limited online engagement	Achieve measurable engagement (track inquiries, newsletters, 10% open rate)
Comparative Benchmarking	KPI reporting, transparency, peer visibility	Annual KPI reporting; integrated analytics	Limited KPI dashboarding; no public performance data	Build KPI dashboard integrating Google Analytics, Search Console, and social metrics by next academic year

CHAPTER 5: DISCUSSIONS & CONCLUSION

5.1 Overview:

In this chapter , I have explained the findings of secondary visibility analysis and primary survey responses which was collected to assess the perceptions, awareness and respondents' motivations related to the program at the Tampere university .

The review of secondary data showed that while Tampere University has a strong digital presence overall, the Public Policy program isn't very visible. The program's online content mixes with general information from the faculty, which reduces its search visibility and makes it harder to stand out from other social science programs. Social media mentions of the Public Policy program are not very common and are not organized. This shows that the program doesn't have a strong, independent brand presence. Also, there's very little use of multimedia storytelling, such as student interviews or alumni features.

These types of content are known to help with engagement and awareness.

5.2 Analytical Implications

- There was no analysis done with internal analytics, but still the phase gave a good starting point for understanding the program's visibility.
- It is understood the program visibility is done and measured by university's overall communication efforts , not on targeted outreach specific to the program There's a gap between how well the university is known and how well the program is recognized.
- Potential future KPI can have both quantitative measures, like website traffic and engagement rates, and qualitative aspects, such as brand clarity and consistent messaging.

5.3 Awareness

The survey results establish that people mostly know about the Public Policy program at Tampere University via social media and personal connections, not through official marketing or ads about a third of the people who took the survey found out about the program through LinkedIn, Instagram, or Facebook. Rest set of third heard about it from friends or alumni.

This indicates that through word-of-mouth and the program's presence on digital platforms are vital for making the program known than targeted university promotions. In comparison, less people have mentioned learning about the program through educational fairs or direct communication from the university.

This also suggests that the program is not getting promoted through traditional promotional ways. These findings match what Hemsley-Brown and Oplatka (2015) said about how social and digital networks are becoming more important in promoting higher education. However, when compared to places like the University of Helsinki, which use joint-degree programs and share research stories actively (Clark, Chapleo & Suomi, 2021), Tampere's program is well-known as an institution but not clearly recognized as a specific program. From a effectiveness of the program promotions standpoint, this means that the program needs to improve its Awareness Key Performance Indicators. These should include website visits, how easy it is to find the program online, and how much attention it gets on social media. Understanding and creating a clear and easy-to-find identity for the should be a ideal first step in making the program more visible and improving its marketing efforts.

5.2 Consideration

The study shows that , the top reasons were career opportunities (80%), international exposure (75%), and interest in research (65%).These reasons indicates and also match what is happening worldwide in public policy education, where students are influenced by things like job chances, global connections, and the credibility of the program (Maringe & Gibbs, 2009).

Some people didn't fully understand what exactly course offers(PPE course) and also there was a confusion among respondents and its difficult for them to tell the difference between Tampere University's program and others. This indicates that people know about the program, but they aren't getting enough detailed information about what the program offers, what it focuses on, or what happens after graduation.

At present, Tampere University can be considered general and focused on the university as a whole, with little attention to the specific stories of the Public Policy program. To address the gap, we should use KPIs that measure how much people engage with digital content, like downloading materials, joining webinars, or accessing brochures. These KPIs can help us track how seriously people are looking into the program. We can then approach based on the numbers

5.3 Decision

This the important stage and that's decision stage .The student journey focuses on things like future job opportunities, Clarity of a program, and what challenges students might face.

These are the main factors affecting prospective students when making a decision and those were language barriers, challenges about job markets, and the cost of living. These concerns are similar to what other studies have found (Hemsley-Brown, 2016; Maringe & Gibbs, 2009), students are more likely to apply and even consider applying if they believe the program will help them get a job after graduation. Even though respondents saw Tampere University as a respected and knowledge gaining place, very few could name specific career paths or partnerships related to the Public Policy program. This can exhibit that there's a gap between how the university is seen overall and how the program itself is presented. To handle this, we could create KPIs like the conversion rate (number of applications compared to inquiries) and the yield rate (number of students who get in versus those who actually enroll).

We can also use qualitative measures to understand if prospective students are able to get the clear messages about potential future career options. If Tampere University can publish about internships, any guidelines or networks with government agencies, and stories from alumni who have successful careers, it can build more trust during the decision stage and reduce the number of people who drop out before applying.

5.4 Retention and Advocacy

This stage shows how current students or alumni from various university communicate with the program once or if they enroll. As per the survey, it represents that there isn't much visibility of alumni/students on the program. It can also be analyzed there are very few organized efforts conducted to promote the program at the student level. It is very difficult to get access to the alumni group and current students might or may not talk about participating in promotional activities or sharing their experiences online. This has made the process of spreading through word of mouth or peer influence difficult.

From the analysis of my case study, university of Helsinki and MUSC university displays policy impact, events that can help to bring people together so that brand image created is strong. To make this stage better, Tampere university could use KPI's like

- Number of alumni stories shared each year Alumni stories shared online or through face -to -face tracking the numbers.
- How often alumni join webinars or open days. Participation of alumni in webinar or open (the count)
- How often the program is mentioned or tagged on social media.(the number count)

In this way, these metrics will help to create a cycle of communication between future prospective students, and past, current better. This will help to create program visibility better as a community

5.6 Conclusion:

After final analysis , it's clear that public policy program at Tampere is not that well known , from the KPI stages ,even though university as such is well reputed but awareness mostly comes for organic sources but consideration stage doesn't have sufficient dept , decision is also influenced by outside factors and also main part is retention is missing from alumni support . Overall survey exhibits that university and program has a gap in how it is shown overall and presented to outside world

Chapleo(2015) observed that university focus on their brand image rather giving attention to program specific . I analyzed, in Tampere's case prospective student sees university goodwill but they are not aware of the program . So, creating structured KPI on marketing funnel (Kotler &Keller 2016) might help to fix the imbalance . This way, system tracks all the stages using data to see how visible the program is.

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THE USE OF AI:

The AI tools utilized in my thesis and their purposes are described below: Names and versions of AI tools: ClaudeAI 3.5 Sonnet, Quillbot v15.505.0 Purpose of using AI tools:

Grammar checking - Quillbot, while primarily a paraphrasing tool, also assists in refining sentence structures and fixing minor grammatical errors. By using this tool, I ensured that the language in the thesis is polished, error-free, and aligned with academic standards, resulting in a document that communicates ideas effectively and professionally.

Sentence Restructuring - One of the primary reasons for using AI tools in this thesis is to restructure and refine sentences to improve coherence and readability.

Complex academic ideas often require careful phrasing to ensure logical flow and clarity, and tools like ClaudeAI and Quillbot are instrumental in achieving this.

ClaudeAI provides alternative ways to phrase sentences while preserving the original meaning, making it easier to communicate complex concepts concisely. It can also break down long sentences into simpler, more digestible parts, improving readability. Quillbot, although used less frequently, assists in rephrasing sentences in different styles, such as enhancing fluency or conciseness, ensuring smoother transitions between ideas. This restructuring ensures that the thesis has a clear, logical flow, making it accessible and engaging for readers.

I have also used "Citefast" to convert my references into APA 7 style.

I also wanted to inform that all the content and information generated are the author's ideas. I acknowledge that I am fully responsible for the entire content of my thesis, including the parts generated by AI, and accept accountability for any violations of ethical standards in publications.

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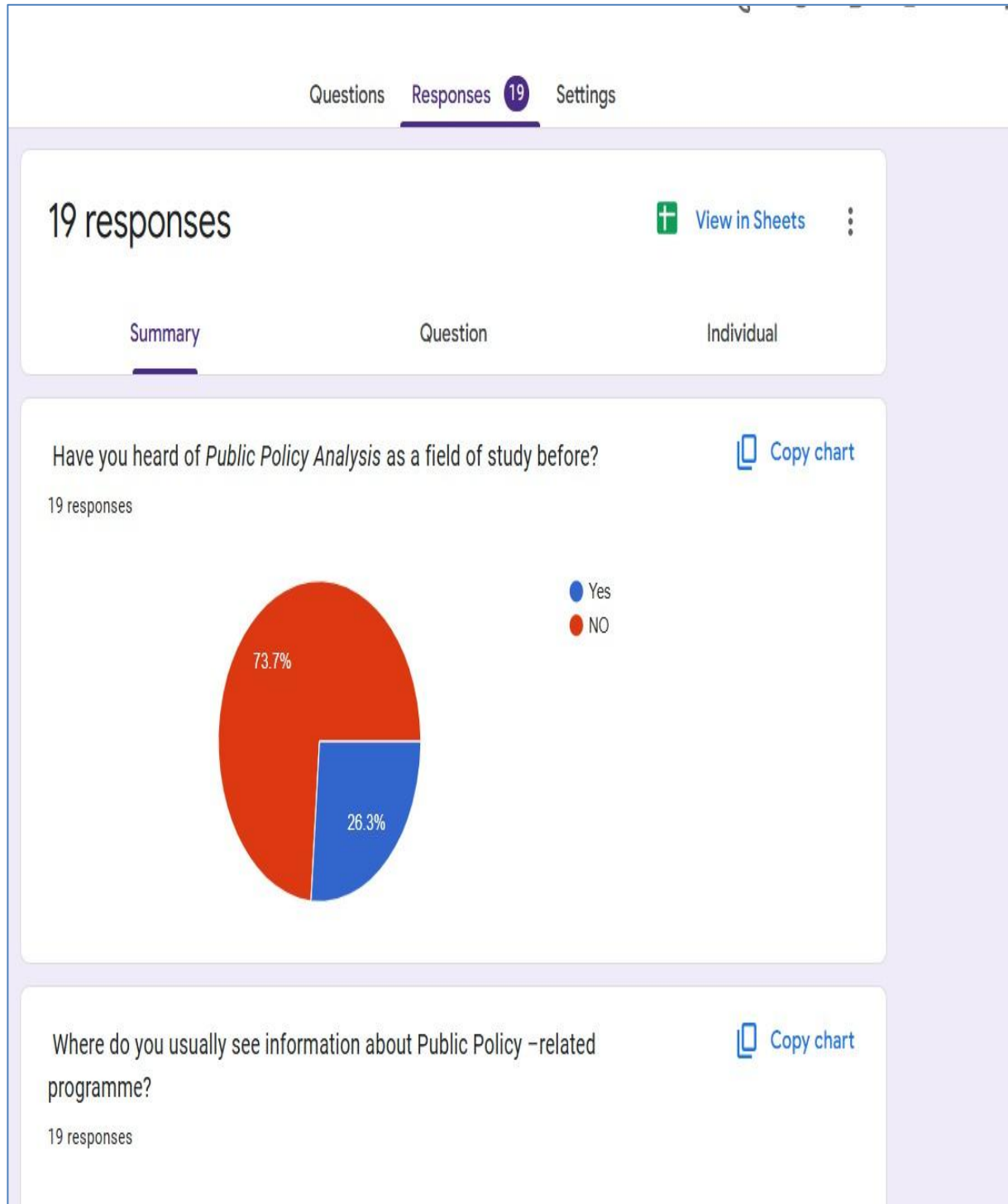
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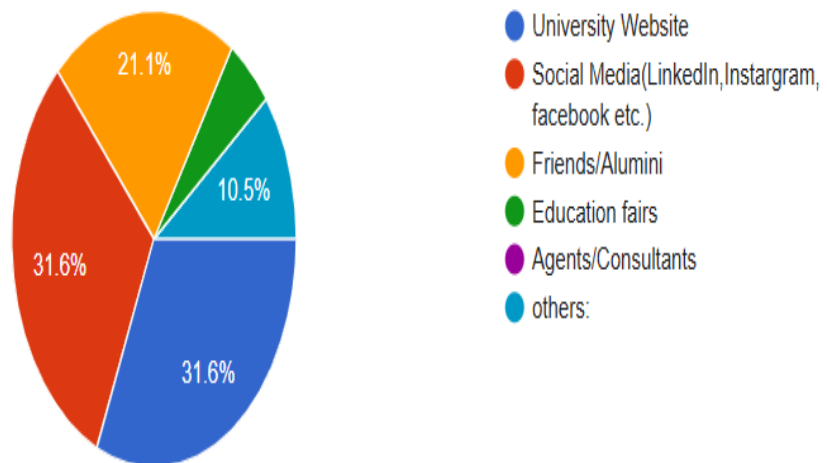
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APPENDICES :**APPENDIX 1: SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE**

programme?

19 responses



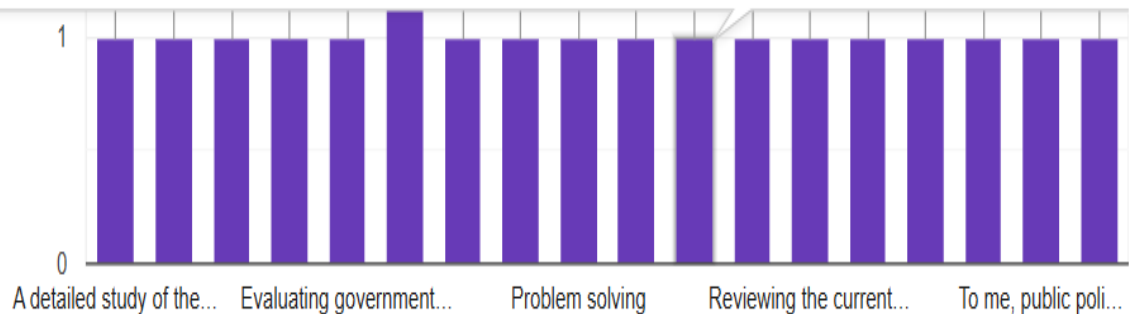
In your own words, what do you think **Public Policy Analysis** means?

[Copy chart](#)

19 responses



Public policy analysis helps to identify problem and identifying potential policy options then comparing those options to choose the best one
Count: 1



How did you first hear about study opportunities in Finland?

19 responses

In recent news channels

Through friends

From a family member who works in Finland

No

Contact

Friend

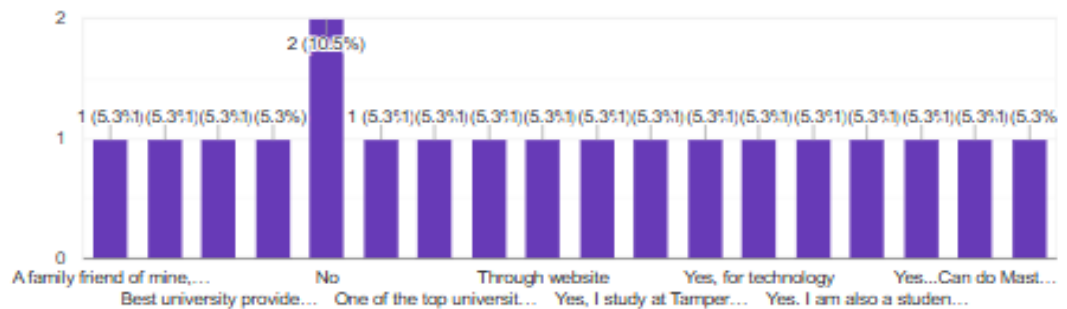
Friend and relatives

I first heard about study opportunities in Finland through my study consultancy in Chennai. They provided detailed information about the quality of education and the supportive learning environment in Finland, which really interested me.

Have you heard about "Tampere University"? if so yes, and what comes to you mind?

[Copy chart](#)

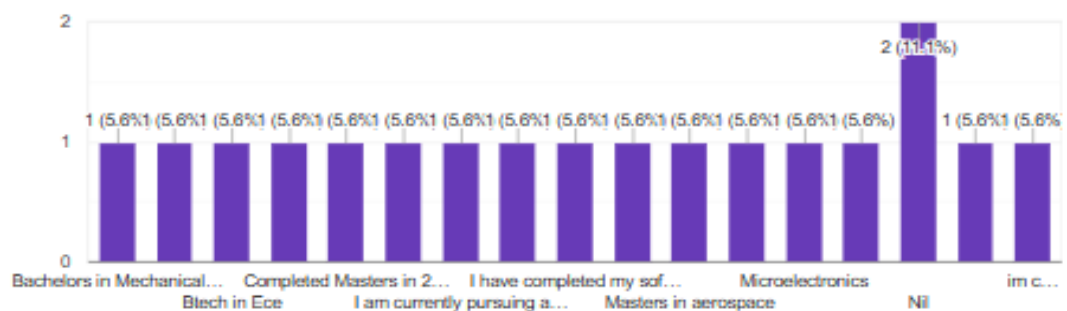
19 responses



What course are you currently studying? or what course have you completed?

[Copy chart](#)

18 responses



What skills or knowledge do you expect to gain from studying **Public Policy Analysis**?

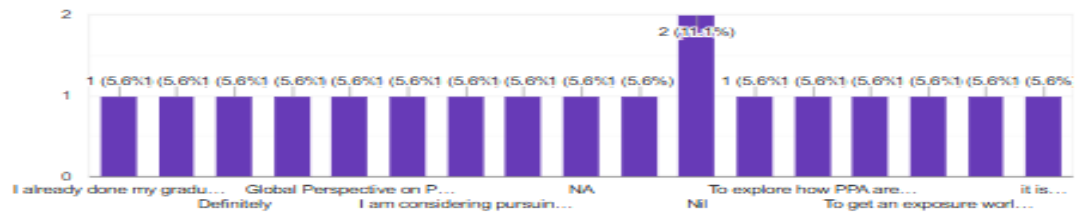
18 responses

- Social responsibilities
- To know about policies that enhance society well being by addressing public problems
- I want to be able to contribute to creating policies that are not only technically but also socially and responsive to the needs.
- Real social impact
- Understanding Policy Processes, Quantitative and Qualitative Methods for evaluating the policy, usability check of the policy
- Getting appropriate solutions for problem solving
- From studying Public Policy Analysis, I expect to gain strong analytical skills to critically evaluate policies and their impacts. I hope to develop a deep understanding of the policy-making process, including how decisions are made and implemented within governments and institutions.

Why would you consider pursuing PPA(public Policy Analysis) abroad instead of in your home country?

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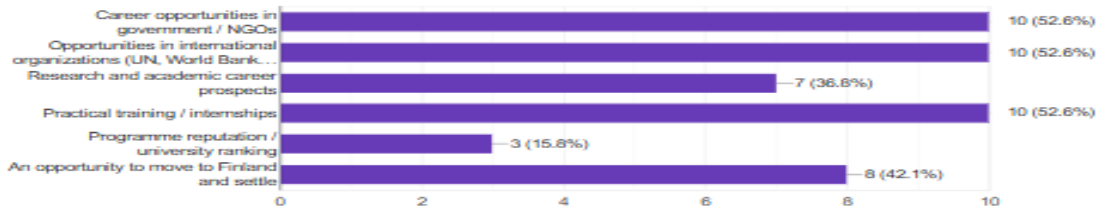
18 responses



Which of these factors make a PPA Programme attractive to you in Finland?

[Copy chart](#)

19 responses



What concerns might stop you from choosing Finland for Public Policy studies? (e.g., cost, climate, language, job market).

17 responses

Climate and job market

Cost

Climate, Language

Language, Climate, Food Choice

Language after completing studies

One concern I have about choosing Finland for Public Policy studies is the job market. While the education system is highly reputable, I am mindful of the challenges in securing employment after graduation, especially in a competitive and relatively small job market.

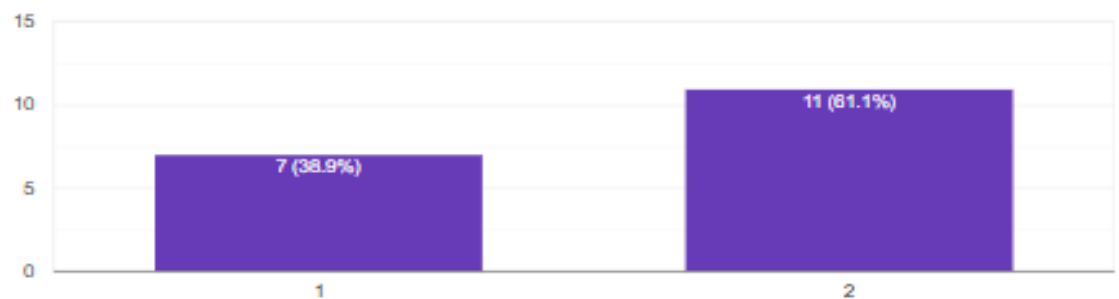
Since Finland is a pretty expensive country, me being from India cannot afford to sustain my studies in Finland, moreover I am not really well aware of Public Policy studies.

Language

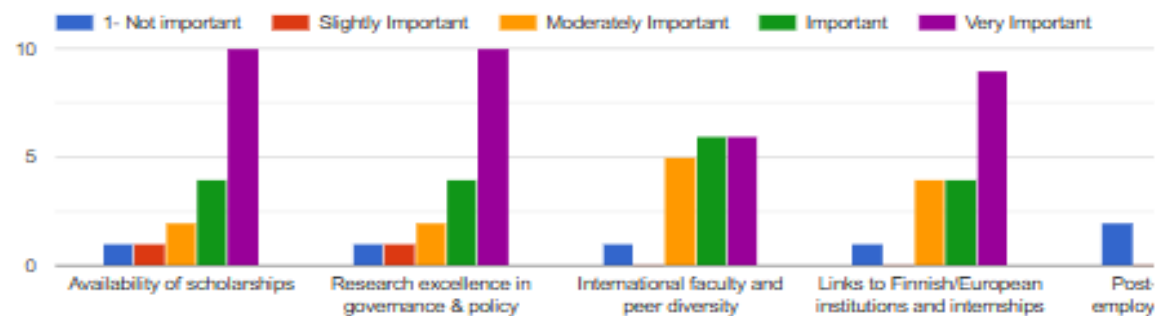
How likely are you to apply to a PPA programme abroad in the next 2 years?
(Likert scale: Very likely – Not likely)

[Copy chart](#)

18 responses



[Copy chart](#)



Please mention your country of residence ? Current level of Study? Field of Study?

18 responses

India

India-masters-data science

India. Masters

My country of residence is India and I have completed my Bachelor's degree in computer science.

U.S., Aerospace

India, PhD, Computer Science

I am currently residing in Finland, pursuing a Master's degree in International Business Management.

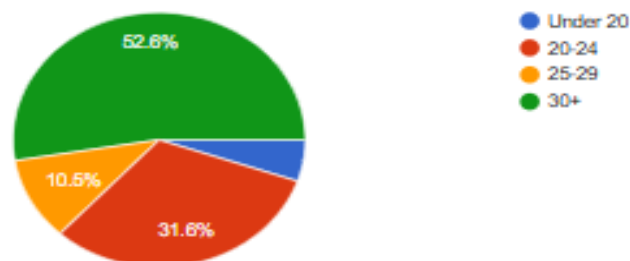
India,currently persuing bachelors in electronics and communication engineering

India. I have done graduation means Bachelar of arts.

Age range

19 responses

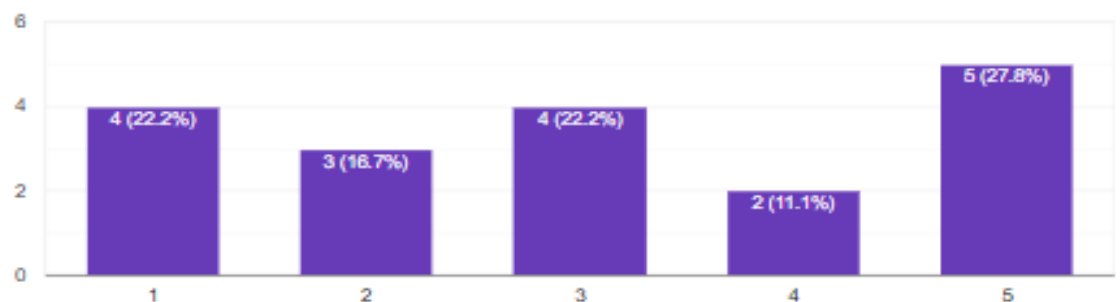
 Copy chart



How important would the following be in choosing Tampere University's programme?

18 responses

 Copy chart



Appendix 2: Table of Figures

FIGURE 1:MARKETING FUNNEL STAGES

TABLE 1 : AWARENESS STAGE OBSERVATION

FIGURE 2: INFORMATION ON PUBLIC POLICY AWARENESS

TABLE 2: CONSIDERATION STAGE :MOTIVATION TO STUDY

FIGURE 3: INFORMATION ON CONSIDERATION PERSPECTIVE

TABLE 3 : DECISION STAGE OBSERVATION

FIGURE 4: INFORMATION ON CONCERNS OF THE RESPONDENTS

TABLE 4: RETENTION STAGE OBSERVATION

FIGURE 5 :INFORMATION ON EXPECTED OUTCOME

FIGURE 6: INFORMATION ON AGE GROUP

TABLE 5: BENCHMARKING

TABLE 6: MUSU CASE STUDY

TABLE7: UNIVERSITY OF HELSINKI CASE STUDY